Interaction Dynamics and Basin Transitions in Constraint-Manifold Evolution

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Abstract

Paper XII [Smart, 2026b] introduced minimal dynamics for single-state evolution within the closure framework. The present paper extends this to multi-state interaction dynamics by defining a total closure functional on product configurations that includes an explicit interaction term. Each state evolves under both its own closure pressure and the mutual influence of other states, through a coupled projected gradient flow.

Interaction is interpreted as deformation of the closure landscape: the presence of one state modifies the effective basin structure experienced by another. Binding corresponds to the formation of a joint attractor whose total closure cost is lower than the separated configuration. Scattering-like processes are represented as basin-crossing or basin-preserving transitions within the coupled dynamics. A conservative Lagrangian extension provides second-order coupled evolution.

The interaction functional is introduced as a minimal structural ansatz with proximity, alignment, compatibility, and binding components. Its specific form is not uniquely derived; it is the simplest multi-state extension consistent with the closure-constraint structure. The paper does not provide scattering amplitudes, cross-sections, or a quantum field theory. It establishes the structural interaction layer from which such extensions could in principle be pursued.

1 Introduction

Paper XII [Smart, 2026b] introduced gradient-flow dynamics for a single state evolving on the closure functional $\mathcal{F}$. Under that evolution, closure-stable states are attractors, the functional decreases monotonically, and disconnected configurations are dynamically unstable. However, the single-state framework cannot address interaction: how one admissible state influences the evolution of another.

Physical theories require interacting configurations. The Standard Model describes interactions through gauge-boson exchange and Lagrangian coupling terms. The present

paper introduces a structural interaction layer within the closure framework that serves an analogous (though formally different) role.

The central idea is straightforward: when multiple states are present, the closure landscape depends on the joint configuration. Each state evolves under its own closure pressure *and* the mutual influence mediated by an interaction functional. This coupled evolution defines the framework's notion of interaction.

Where Paper VIII [Smart, 2026a] treated connectedness as a static closure condition on composite admissibility, the present paper studies how multiple states dynamically reshape one another's closure basins and thereby generate binding, repulsion, and transition behaviour.

Scope and epistemic status

This paper extends the minimal dynamics of Paper XII to multi-state systems. The interaction functional is a structural ansatz: it is not derived from a gauge principle or uniquely determined by the closure structure. The paper defines the interaction architecture and its dynamical consequences, not a complete interacting quantum theory.

2 Multi-State Admissible Space

We extend the single-state admissible domain $\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}$ to an n-state configuration space:

$$\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}^{(n)} = \underbrace{\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}} \times \mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}} \times \cdots \times \mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}}_{n} \tag{1}$$

with elements:

$$\Psi = (\psi_1, \psi_2, \ldots, \psi_n) \tag{2}$$

where each $\psi_i \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}$.

The product space is equipped with the natural product inner product:

$$\langle \Psi, \Phi \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \langle \psi_i, \phi_i \rangle \tag{3}$$

and corresponding norm $\|\Psi\|^2 = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \|\psi_i\|^2$.

This is the minimal setting in which interaction between distinct states can be defined.

3 The Total Closure Functional

For a multi-state configuration $\Psi = (\psi_1, \ldots, \psi_n)$, the total closure functional is:

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi) = \sum_{i=1}^{n} \mathcal{F}(\psi_i) + \mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\Psi) \tag{4}$$

where:

- $\mathcal{F}(\psi_i)$ is the single-state closure functional from Paper XII (intrinsic closure cost of each state),
- $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\Psi)$ is the interaction functional (mutual influence between states).

Without the interaction term, the total functional is separable: each state evolves independently. The interaction functional $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$ couples the evolution and is the source of all multi-state phenomena in the framework.

4 The Interaction Functional

The interaction functional is introduced as a structural deformation term on the joint closure landscape. At the present level of development, it is a minimal ansatz composed of four structurally motivated components:

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\Psi) = \lambda_1 \, I_{\text{prox}}(\Psi) + \lambda_2 \, I_{\text{align}}(\Psi) + \lambda_3 \, I_{\text{comp}}(\Psi) + \lambda_4 \, I_{\text{bind}}(\Psi) \tag{5}$$

where $\lambda_i > 0$ are structural weights, not derived in this paper. The interaction functional is assumed to be symmetric under permutation of states: $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\psi_1, \ldots, \psi_n) = \mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\psi_{\sigma(1)}, \ldots, \psi_{\sigma(n)})$ for any permutation σ, ensuring that no state is intrinsically privileged within the interaction structure.

4.1 Proximity term

The proximity term measures how close states are in the ambient state space:

$$I_{\text{prox}}(\Psi) = \sum_{i<j} f(\|\psi_i - \psi_j\|) \tag{6}$$

where f is a monotone function (e.g. $f(r) = e^{-r^2/\sigma^2}$ for a localised interaction, or $f(r) = r^2$ for a long-range harmonic coupling). States that are closer in the ambient space interact more strongly. The choice of f determines whether proximity contributes effectively as attraction or repulsion within the total interaction landscape; in the present work this freedom is left explicit as part of the structural ansatz, rather than fixed by an additional principle.

4.2 Alignment term

The alignment term measures torsional or phase compatibility between states:

$$I_{\text{align}}(\Psi) = \sum_{i<j} (1 - \mathcal{A}(\psi_i, \psi_j)) \tag{7}$$

where $\mathcal{A}(\psi_i, \psi_j) \in [0, 1]$ is an alignment functional measuring phase or torsional compatibility. Perfectly aligned states have $\mathcal{A} = 1$ (zero alignment cost); maximally misaligned states have $\mathcal{A} = 0$ (maximum cost).

4.3 Compatibility term

The compatibility term distinguishes cooperative from incompatible configurations:

$$I_{\text{comp}}(\Psi) = \sum_{i<j} \Gamma(\psi_i, \psi_j) \tag{8}$$

where Γ is small for compatible state pairs and large for incompatible ones. Compatibility is determined by the constraint-class structure: states whose supports, winding numbers, and torsional configurations are mutually consistent have low Γ.

4.4 Binding term

The binding term rewards jointly connected configurations by penalising residual gaps in the union of supports:

$$I_{\text{bind}}(\Psi) = \Xi_{\text{joint}}(\Psi) \tag{9}$$

where Ξ_{joint} is the gap penalty of the union of supports (Paper VIII [Smart, 2026a]). Connected composite configurations have $\Xi_{\text{joint}} = 0$, while disconnected unions have $\Xi_{\text{joint}} > 0$. Through the positive weight λ_4, disconnected joint configurations therefore raise the total closure cost, while connected composites are favoured relative to them. Thus the binding component does not introduce an independent attractive force; rather, it lowers the relative closure cost of jointly connected configurations by penalising disconnected unions.

Remark 1 (Ansatz status)**.** *The decomposition (5) and the specific forms of I_{prox}, I_{align}, I_{comp}, I_{bind} are minimal structural ansätze. They are not derived from a gauge principle or uniquely determined by the closure structure. Their role is to define the interaction architecture; a more fundamental derivation of $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$ is left for future work.*

5 Coupled Gradient Dynamics

The multi-state evolution is defined by gradient flow of the total closure functional:

$$\frac{d\Psi}{dt} = -\Pi_{\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}^{(n)}}(\nabla \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi)) \tag{10}$$

Componentwise, each state evolves under both its intrinsic closure pressure and the interaction gradient:

$$\frac{d\psi_i}{dt} = -\Pi_{\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}}(\nabla_{\psi_i}\mathcal{F}(\psi_i) + \nabla_{\psi_i}\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\Psi)) \tag{11}$$

for $i = 1, \ldots, n$.

The first term drives ψ_i toward its own closure; the second term encodes the influence of all other states on ψ_i's evolution. Without the interaction term, the evolution is decoupled and reduces to n independent copies of Paper XII dynamics. In particular, the coupled dynamics reduces exactly to the single-state gradient flow of Paper XII in the limit $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}} \to 0$.

6 Monotonic Descent

Proposition 2 (Multi-state monotonic descent)**.** *Along trajectories of the coupled projected gradient flow (10), the total closure functional decreases monotonically:*

$$\frac{d\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}}{dt} = -\left\|\Pi_{\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}^{(n)}}(\nabla \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi))\right\|^2 \leq 0 \tag{12}$$

Proof. Identical to the single-state case (Proposition 1 of Paper XII): $d\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}/dt = \langle \nabla \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}, d\Psi/dt\rangle = -\|\Pi(\nabla \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}})\|^2 \leq 0$. Here $\Pi_{\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}^{(n)}}$ is the orthogonal projection onto the tangent space of the admissible product domain with respect to the product inner product. □

This ensures the interacting system is mathematically stable in the same sense as the single-state dynamics: the total closure cost never increases along trajectories.

7 Basin Deformation and Interaction

7.1 Interaction as landscape deformation

Without interaction ($\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}} = 0$), the total closure landscape is a sum of independent single-state landscapes. Each state has its own attractor basins, determined by $\mathcal{F}(\psi_i)$ alone.

With interaction ($\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}} \neq 0$), the joint landscape $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi)$ differs from the sum of individual landscapes. The attractor basins of the coupled system are *not* simply the product of the individual basins; they are deformed by $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$.

Remark 3 (Interaction as basin deformation)**.** *Interaction is interpreted within the present framework as a modification of one state's effective closure landscape by the presence of another. The interaction term $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$ deforms the basin structure of the joint dynamical system, potentially:*

- *shifting attractor positions,*
- *merging or splitting basins,*
- *lowering or raising barriers between basins,*
- *creating new joint attractors not present in the uncoupled system.*

Equivalently, for each component ψ_i, one may define an effective single-state functional:

$$\mathcal{F}_i^{\text{eff}}(\psi_i; \Psi_{\neq i}) = \mathcal{F}(\psi_i) + \mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\Psi) \tag{13}$$

where $\Psi_{\neq i}$ denotes all components other than ψ_i, held fixed. The gradient of $\mathcal{F}_i^{\text{eff}}$ with respect to ψ_i then recovers the componentwise evolution equation (11). Interaction can thus be viewed as a state-dependent deformation of the intrinsic closure landscape.

7.2 Interaction types

Different components of $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$ produce different basin deformations:

- **Proximity:** states that are close in state space experience stronger mutual landscape modification.
- **Alignment:** torsionally compatible states have lower interaction cost, favouring aligned configurations.
- **Compatibility:** incompatible state pairs raise barriers; compatible pairs lower them.
- **Binding:** the binding term creates new joint minima for connected composite configurations.

8 Binding as Joint Basin Formation

Definition 4 (Bound configuration)**.** *A multi-state configuration* $\Psi^* = (\psi_1^*, \ldots, \psi_n^*)$ *is a bound configuration if it is closure-stable under the total functional and energetically preferred over the separated configuration:*

$$\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*) < \sum_{i=1}^{n} \mathcal{F}(\psi_i^*) \tag{14}$$

Binding corresponds to the formation of joint attractors for which the total closure cost $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*)$ is lower than the cost of the separated configuration, due to deformation of the closure landscape by the interaction functional rather than a reduction of intrinsic single-state closure cost. The bound configuration is a composite that is "cheaper" to close than its separated parts, and it occupies a joint attractor basin not present in the uncoupled system.

Remark 5. *This quantity plays the role of a structural binding measure within the framework: the difference* $\sum \mathcal{F}(\psi_i) - \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*)$ *quantifies how much the interaction lowers the total closure cost relative to the separated configuration.*

9 Scattering-Like Processes

A scattering-like process within the present framework is a trajectory in $\mathcal{S}_{\text{adm}}^{(n)}$ in which:

1. two or more states approach (the interaction term becomes significant),
2. the trajectory passes through a transient interaction region (where $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$ is non-negligible),
3. the final configuration exits into the same or different attractor basins.

Remark 6 (Terminology)**.** *The term "scattering-like" is used to indicate structural analogy with scattering processes in particle physics. The present framework does not provide scattering amplitudes, cross-sections, differential rates, or S-matrix elements. "Scattering-like" refers only to basin-crossing or basin-preserving transitions within the coupled closure dynamics.*

10 Transition Channels

The coupled dynamics admits several structurally distinct interaction outcomes:

Table 1: Structural interaction outcomes.

Channel	Description	Basin structure
Basin-preserving	States interact transiently, return to original basins	No basin change
Basin-transition	One or more states end in different attractors	Basin crossing
Binding / fusion	A new joint attractor is formed	Basin merger
Repulsive separation	Interaction raises closure cost, states diverge	Basin repulsion

Which channel is realised depends on the initial configuration, the strength and form of $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$, and the global basin structure of $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}$.

11 Worked Examples

Example 7 (Disconnected quark-like + complementary support)**.** *Consider a state ψ_1 with disconnected support $\{2,4\}$ (quark-like, with positive gap penalty) and a state ψ_2 with support $\{3\}$. Individually, ψ_1 is not closure-stable. Under the coupled dynamics with the binding term active, the joint configuration $\Psi = (\psi_1, \psi_2)$ can evolve toward a connected composite on $\{2,3,4\}$ with $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*) < \mathcal{F}(\psi_1) + \mathcal{F}(\psi_2)$. This models, within the present framework, the formation of a connected baryon-like composite from initially disconnected components.*

Example 8 (Compatible aligned pair)**.** *Two closure-stable states $\psi_1, \psi_2 \in \mathcal{S}_{\text{cl}}$ with high torsional alignment ($\mathcal{A} \approx 1$) and compatible supports interact with low $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$. The total closure cost is slightly below the sum: $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*) \lesssim \mathcal{F}(\psi_1) + \mathcal{F}(\psi_2)$. A weakly bound joint attractor forms, modelling a loosely bound composite.*

Example 9 (Incompatible pair)**.** *Two states with incompatible torsional configurations ($\mathcal{A} \approx 0$) and high compatibility penalty (Γ large) have $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}} > 0$, raising the total closure cost above the separated sum. No joint attractor forms; the interaction is repulsive in the closure-landscape sense.*

12 Conservative Extension

As in Paper XII, a conservative extension is obtained by introducing a multi-state Lagrangian:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi, \dot{\Psi}) = \frac{1}{2}\|\dot{\Psi}\|^2 - \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi) \tag{15}$$

with action:

$$S[\Psi] = \int_{t_1}^{t_2} \mathcal{L}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi, \dot{\Psi})\, dt \tag{16}$$

The Euler–Lagrange equations are:

$$\ddot{\Psi} = -\nabla \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi) \tag{17}$$

Under the conservative dynamics, multi-state configurations oscillate around joint attractors rather than dissipating toward them. Scattering-like processes become time-reversible trajectories through the interaction region.

Remark 10. *The multi-state Lagrangian is the simplest conservative extension compatible with $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}$. As in Paper XII, the kinetic term is the standard quadratic form on the product space; it is not claimed to be unique.*

13 Physical Interpretation

The interaction framework admits the following structural translations:

Status: These translations are structural correspondences within the framework. They do not claim equivalence with the dynamical content of quantum field theory.

Table 2: Physics correspondence for the interaction layer.

Physical concept	Framework counterpart
Interaction / coupling	Deformation of closure landscape by $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$
Binding measure (structural analogue)	$\sum \mathcal{F}(\psi_i) - \mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*)$
Bound state	Joint attractor of coupled dynamics
Scattering event	Basin-crossing trajectory (scattering-like)
Repulsion	Interaction raising total closure cost
Gauge-boson exchange	Not derived (open)
Cross-section / amplitude	Not computable (open)

14 Limitations

- **No S-matrix or scattering amplitudes.** The framework does not produce cross-sections, differential rates, or matrix elements.
- **No relativistic collision kinematics.** The evolution parameter t is auxiliary; Lorentz-invariant scattering is not defined.
- **No quantisation.** The dynamics is classical (deterministic gradient flow or Lagrangian mechanics).
- **The interaction functional is a minimal ansatz.** It is not derived from a gauge principle or uniquely determined by the closure structure.
- **The structural weights λ_i are not fixed.** They are structural parameters of the interaction ansatz.
- **No derivation of gauge-boson exchange.** The interaction term $\mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}$ is a direct state-state coupling, not mediated by an exchange particle.
- **Worked examples are schematic.** They illustrate the structural possibilities without numerical computation.

15 Conclusion

The closure framework, previously restricted to single-state dynamics (Paper XII), now supports multi-state interaction through a total closure functional $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}} = \sum \mathcal{F}(\psi_i) + \mathcal{F}_{\text{int}}(\Psi)$. Each state evolves under both its own closure pressure and the mutual influence of other states. The total functional decreases monotonically under coupled gradient flow, ensuring mathematical stability.

Interaction is interpreted as deformation of the closure landscape: the presence of one state modifies the effective basin structure experienced by another. Binding corresponds to the formation of joint attractors for which the total closure cost $\mathcal{F}_{\text{tot}}(\Psi^*)$ is lower than that of the separated configuration, arising from deformation of the closure landscape by the interaction functional. Scattering-like processes are basin-crossing or basin-preserving transitions within the coupled dynamics.

This paper therefore marks the transition from single-state closure dynamics to interacting closure dynamics. The framework still does not provide quantum scattering theory,

gauge-field mediation, or relativistic collision physics, but it now possesses the minimal structural machinery required for such questions to be posed internally. In that sense, Paper XIII establishes the minimal structural interaction layer required for the closure framework to move beyond isolated attractors toward a genuinely relational description of physical systems.

References

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